

smell and taste

nasal fossae

Each of two cavities separated by a middle partition; they assist in olfaction, respiration and speech.

frontal sinus

Cavity hollowed out of the frontal bone of the skull; it connects with the nasal fossae and warms inhaled air.

superior nasal concha

Curved bony plate resting on the ethmoid and contributing to olfaction by bringing inhaled air into contact with the mucous membrane.

nasal bone

Small flat bone forming the skeleton of the root of the nose; the two nasal bones join along the bridge of the nose.

septal cartilage of nose

Plate of resistant elastic tissue; it extends the bones of the nose and separates the nasal fossae.

middle nasal concha

Curved bony plate resting on the ethmoid. Among its functions, the nasal chamber warms inhaled air by increasing the mucous surface.

greater alar cartilage

Thin plate of resistant elastic tissue supporting the bridge of the nose and delimiting the contour of the nostril.

inferior nasal concha

Curved bony plate attached to the lateral wall of the nasal fossae.

olfactory bulb

Nerve structure where fibers of the olfactory nerve end; it receives nervous impulses from the mucous membrane and transmits them to the olfactory tract.

olfactory nerve

Bundle of nerve fibers formed by the axons of the mucous membrane's olfactory cells, which transmit nerve impulses to the brain.

olfactory tract

Nerve structure containing the axons; it enables nerve impulses from the bulb to be carried to the brain, where they are interpreted.

olfactory mucosa

Tissue lining a portion of the nasal fossae and containing olfactory cells, which detect odors and release nerve impulses.

hard palate

Bony section of the wall dividing the mouth from the nasal cavity; it is extended by the soft palate.

tongue

Flexible muscular structure of the oral cavity; it helps in tasting, masticating and ingesting food, and also facilitates speech.

